



Open Blinds

I check my phone. I see the news about how in one country people are starving and children are dying. And now I am stuck, and tears from my eyes come falling, and my heart hurts. I feel pain. From my childhood, I used to think that if you were a bad person, then everything bad would happen to you, but were those people that bad to live such a life? What bad things had those children done? Pure innocence is all they are! So 'Why? Where are the world's billionaires? Why are they not getting them out?' I feel pain.

In the past, I used to cry in the bathroom. As I got older, I learned how to hold my tears, hide my sadness and anger, and find relief from listening to songs. Whenever I make tough plans, I think about how pain is making me stronger. Thus, 'Why should I avoid problems and pain?' Now I know if there is something you don't like, let yourself be soaked in it; only then you can continue achieving what you want to.

Daytime, I just prepared a meal for my family and rushed back to my room to continue doing what I was extremely passionate about: coding. But here comes my mom, says, 'Why would you try so hard, even if you obviously can't achieve that? It's just a hobby to you, so don't waste your time and prepare yourself to be a teacher or doctor!'.

Around 8 PM, I didn't have lunch; my father and sister were not at home, and my mom with my brothers just finished having lunch and called me to clean the kitchen and wash the dishes, but I was in the main part of my coding and didn't want to stop it there and asked, can't my brother do that instead of me, or can't they give me some time to finish my project first? But again, my mother says, 'Why should we give you an opportunity or time to study instead of your brother when we know that one day you will get married and leave us?'.

I work hard, I want to be the greatest, and I want to achieve a lot of things, not in order to have a luxurious life but to create a beautiful life for others and prevent every problem I faced and facing from happening to them. I don't want people to experience the negative feelings I had in the past. I want to be a revolution for them.

I love people since I believe that everyone is equal, and even if they choose the wrong path, it is not their fault; it is their environment that shaped them. So far, I have done my best to help people who live around the Aral Sea, became a gender equality leader, organized a hackathon to give them an opportunity to showcase themselves and find out their own potential, and organized lessons to make them dive deeper into what they love. I had no one to teach me the depth of my interest, so I became one for others. Now I am keen on researching quantum computers deeper and leaving my mark on the biggest open source projects and becoming diva developer for others.

I was sitting on the armchair in the corridor during the break when the group of girls started pointing at me and whispering to each other, 'Maftuna Vohidjonovna, Maftuna Vohidjonovna!' with respect and amazement. I felt happy; I felt excited about myself for the first time.

Now at 2:30 AM, a cold, dark night, and in one small room, an alarm with the song 'Open Blinds' starts ringing. I wake up, and no matter how hard I want to sleep, I go to wash my face since I know there is a world waiting for my help!